Human-made Things in the Bible © United Bible Societies, 2025. Adapted from: The Works of Their Hands: Man-made Things in the Bible, by Ray Pritz © 2009 United Bible Societies. This work is licensed under Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/).

Saw

1.12.5 Saw

Reference:

Greek πρίζω (prizō (verb)) HEB 11:37

Description and usage:

Depiction of a carpenter on a mural in the burial chamber of the sculptors Nebamun and Ipuki (Eloquence, Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons)The saw was a flat tool with a serrated edge, used for cutting objects in two. It could be made of hard stone such as flint or of metal and was sometimes fitted with a handle.

Translation:

HEB 11:37: It may not be necessary to be so precise about the instrument here. NCV “cut in half” adequately conveys the idea.